

Scikit — Pricing Research & Launch Pricing

Australian web design, SEO, website care and managed IT pricing · researched 27 September 2026 · internal document

Purpose

Know the market rates for what we sell, and decide what Scikit should charge when we launch. We checked 42 URLs (35 loaded, 7 failed): 38 providers, 29 of which publish prices, plus 10 pricing guides. All prices are AUD. Where we compare, inc-GST prices are converted to ex GST ($\div 1.1$).

Key findings

- **Websites:** the Melbourne mid-market for a 5–15 page small business site is **\$1,700–\$3,500 ex GST** (VisualWeb, Dynamic Websites, Christom, Brandflow, Foxie). Custom and premium builds start around \$5,000. Our planned \$3,500 Starter sits at the **top** of the mid band, which is a hard sell with no portfolio yet.
- **E-commerce:** budget and mid builds cost \$3,000–\$5,000 (VisualWeb from \$4,990), and premium builds \$12,500+. Our planned \$12,000 is premium pricing.
- **SEO:** guides agree small businesses spend **\$800–\$3,500/month**, and several say under ~\$500 isn't a real service. Our \$790 / \$1,490 plans sit in the low-to-mid band, **well positioned**.
- **Care plans:** budget plans are \$30–\$80/month (VisualWeb from \$32.95). Mid plans with 30–120 minutes of edits are \$100–\$260. Our \$99 Essentials has no cheap entry point below it. Our \$249 and \$599 plans are in line with the mid and premium bands.
- **Hourly rate:** guides quote \$150–\$300/hr. Our \$150 is at the **bottom** of the range, which is fine for launch.
- **Managed IT:** \$60–\$180 per user per month. Our flat \$599 Complete plan is not a like-for-like competitor with a full managed IT service, so position it as care plus admin, not a full helpdesk.

Recommended launch pricing (summary)

Item	Current draft	Recommended at launch	Why
Website: Starter (up to 5 pages)	\$3,500	\$2,990	Top of the mid band, but below \$3,500 so we win early jobs. Market: \$1,700–\$3,500.
Website: Growth (up to 12 pages, bookings, blog)	\$7,500	\$5,500	Between mid (\$3,490 VisualWeb Pro) and premium (\$6,500+). Engineering quality justifies it.
Website: Commerce	\$12,000	\$7,900	Market budget/mid \$3k–\$5k, premium \$12.5k+. \$7,900 is a credible mid-premium price.
Founding-client offer	—	20% off first 5 clients	In exchange for a case study, a Google review and permission to show the site. Time-limited and genuine.
SEO: Local SEO setup (one-off)	\$1,500	\$990	Market one-off \$800–\$2,500. Free with a Growth website.
SEO: Local plan	\$790/mo	\$790/mo	Keep. Low-mid band. Above the 'too cheap to be real' line.
SEO: Growth plan	\$1,490/mo	\$1,490/mo	Keep. Matches Australian Web Experts Local (\$1,490) and Digital Next (\$1,450).
Hosting only (new)	—	\$39/mo	New entry tier to compete with \$30–\$60 hosting. Hosting, SSL, backups, updates. No edits.
Care: Essentials	\$99/mo	\$89/mo	Includes 30 min of edits. Website4U \$79, GoldenWeb \$129.
Care: Business	\$249/mo	\$229/mo	Matches GoldenWeb Pro and Website4U Pro (\$229).
Care: Complete (with Microsoft 365 admin)	\$599/mo	\$549/mo	Premium band (\$300+). About the cost of 7 users on Melbit's \$79 entry plan (\$553).
Hourly rate	\$150/hr	\$150/hr	Bottom of the \$150–\$300 range. Revisit after 10 projects.

All prices ex GST. Recommended prices are a judgement based on the data below, not a market fact. Revisit after the first 10 projects or 6 months.

Recommendations in detail

1. Pricing strategy

- **Price in the upper-mid band, not budget.** Our story is 'built by engineers'. Budget pricing (\$300–\$1,500) undercuts that story and attracts clients who want the cheapest option. Competing with VisualWeb on price is a race we don't need to win.
- **Discount the first few jobs openly, not the list price.** A founding-client discount (20% off the first 5 clients) gets us the portfolio and reviews we need, without anchoring the market to a low price. When the offer ends, prices stay where they are.
- **Recurring revenue is the business.** Websites are one-off. Hosting, care and SEO pay every month. Bundle them: every website quote includes 3 months of Business care, then the client chooses to continue.
- **Keep 'from' prices public.** Only a minority of competitors publish prices. Doing so builds trust and filters out clients who can't afford us.

2. Sanity check: effective hourly rate

Package	Launch price	Est. hours	Effective rate
Starter website	\$2,990	18–24 hrs	\$125–\$166/hr
Growth website	\$5,500	35–45 hrs	\$122–\$157/hr
Commerce website	\$7,900	50–65 hrs	\$122–\$158/hr
SEO Local (monthly)	\$790	5–6 hrs	\$132–\$158/hr
SEO Growth (monthly)	\$1,490	9–11 hrs	\$135–\$165/hr
Care Business (monthly)	\$229	~1.5 hrs (assumes clients use about half their 2 hrs)	~\$150/hr

Hours are estimates for two senior engineers using modern tooling and templates for the build foundations. If a package regularly takes longer, raise its price or cut its scope. Don't absorb the extra time.

3. Packaging tips from the market

- Name packages simply. Starter / Growth / Commerce matches market language (VisualWeb, Brandflow).
- State the page count, turnaround and what's included. Every competitor with clear pricing does.
- Offer month-to-month SEO after a 3-month minimum. 'No lock-in' is a common selling point (Sejuce, Digital Next, Australian Web Experts).
- Quote a set allowance of edit minutes or hours in care plans (30 / 60 / 120 min is the norm).
- Avoid subscription website builds (\$249–\$399/mo with 12–24 month minimums). They look cheap up front, clients distrust the lock-in, and it clashes with our 'you own everything' promise.

4. GST note

Businesses must register for GST once annual turnover reaches \$75,000. Until Scikit is registered, it can't charge GST, so show prices as final ('no GST charged') or register voluntarily from day one. Voluntary registration lets us claim GST credits on equipment and software, and our 'ex GST' price display then stays correct. Confirm with your accountant.

Market price bands

Summary of the provider data. Ex GST (inc-GST prices divided by 1.1).

Category	Budget	Mid	Premium	Scikit (launch)
Brochure website (~5–15 pages)	\$300–\$1,500 Webeasy, AusWeb, Edgezone, Bruce Langdon	\$1,700–\$3,500 VisualWeb, Dynamic, Christom, Foxie, Brandflow, EG Solutions, Code & Visual	\$5,000–\$17,500+ Dizian, Brandflow, Web Apex, Code & Visual	\$2,990 / \$5,500
E-commerce website	\$3,000–\$5,000 AusWeb, Foxie, Edgezone, VisualWeb	\$5,000–\$10,000	\$12,500+ Web Apex; Shopify \$10k–\$20k+	\$7,900
Subscription websites	\$39–\$59/mo (Social Space)	\$249–\$399/mo, 12-month min (DIGITALON, Localsearch)	—	Not offered
SEO (monthly)	\$250–\$900 SEO First Page, Social Space, Low Cost SEO Plans, Sejuce, BeKonstructive	\$1,000–\$2,500 EG, Web Apex, Digital Next, Australian Web Experts	\$2,500–\$6,600+ SOUP, Spicy Web, Firewire	\$790 / \$1,490
Care / maintenance (monthly)	\$30–\$80 VisualWeb, Kitsune, Website4U	\$100–\$260 GoldenWeb, Website4U, Fox & Lee, VisualWeb managed	\$300+ GoldenWeb VIP, Fox & Lee Expert, Dizian	\$39 / \$89 / \$229 / \$549
Managed IT (per user/month)	\$35–\$110 All IT, Melbit, Milnsbridge	\$119–\$180 Milnsbridge, Melbit, All IT	\$199–\$280 All IT Premium; Intellect IT range	Flat \$549 (care + admin)
Hourly rate	\$100/hr (Website4U)	\$150–\$250/hr (guides)	\$250–\$300/hr (guides)	\$150/hr

Provider data

Prices exactly as published. 'Verified' = the page was fetched and checked on 27 Sep 2026. The fetch tool summarises each page, so check any figure before quoting it publicly. 'GST ?' = the page doesn't say.

A. Website design & build packages

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
VisualWeb	Melbourne	Single Page	\$1,699 +GST	1 page, copywriting, imagery, form; 1 week	Yes
VisualWeb	Melbourne	Small Business	\$2,490 +GST	Up to 7 pages, service/location pages, local SEO structure	Yes
VisualWeb	Melbourne	Business Pro	\$3,490 +GST	Up to 15 pages, bookings/calculator, CRM, advanced SEO	Yes
VisualWeb	Melbourne	eCommerce	from \$4,990 +GST	WooCommerce, up to 50 products; 5–7 weeks	Yes
Dynamic Websites	Melbourne	Starter / Pro	\$1,895 / \$2,250 inc GST	5 pages, domain, 12 months hosting; Pro adds copy and stock photos	Yes
Bruce Langdon Design	Melbourne	Small Business	\$595 setup + \$40/mo +GST	24-month minimum; unlimited pages, hosting, email	Yes
Christom	Melbourne	5-page site	from \$2,915 +GST	E-commerce ~\$895–\$8,000 +GST (FAQ)	Yes
Dizian Digital	Melbourne	Custom site	from \$4,995 ex GST	Custom marketing site	Yes
Dyghiphy	Melbourne	Website / + branding	\$1,899 / \$2,899 inc GST	From search snippet only	No
Web Apex	AU	1 page / Std / Business / eCom	\$2,500 / \$6,500 / \$9,500 / \$12,500 ex GST	'General guide' calculator	Yes
EG Solutions	Sydney	Launch	from \$3,500 +GST	Up to 8 pages, SEO, GBP, hosting, 30 days support	Yes
Code and Visual	Sydney	Small / Med / Large	from \$3,200 / \$8,500 / \$17,500 ex GST	1–3 / 5–10 / 10–20 pages	Yes
AusWeb Design	Sydney	DIY / Starter / Custom / eCom	from \$199 / \$999 / \$1,999 / \$2,999 (GST ?)	10–20 pages; WooCommerce with 20 products	Yes
Small Business Web Designs	Sydney	Single page	\$299 +GST	Extra pages \$150	Partial
Edgezone Media	Syd–Gold Coast	Std / eCom / Membership	from \$850 / \$4,500 / \$3,500 (GST ?)	Plus a monthly subscription; extra pages \$375	Yes
Foxie Web Design	Central Coast	Landing to eCom M	\$1,200 – \$4,000 (GST ?)	Small Biz up to 10 pages, 1st year hosting	Yes
Webeasy	Brisbane	1 / 3 / 5 pages	\$695 / \$845 / \$995 (special; GST ?)	Normally \$995–\$1,495	Yes
Brandflow	Brisbane	Basic to Ultimate	\$2,800 / \$4,800 / \$7,200 / \$9,600 (GST ?)	3 / 5 / 10 / 15 pages	Yes
Social Space	AU	Starter / Core	\$199 setup + \$39 or \$59/mo inc GST	Subscription, month-to-month	Yes
DIGITALON	Sunshine Coast	Subscription	\$249 / \$299 / \$399 per month inc GST	12-month minimum; 5–20 pages, hosting, email	Yes
Localsearch	National	Website subscription	from \$299/mo (GST ?)	Setup fee and term not stated	Yes
Swift Productions	Sydney	Shopify	Not published	Snippet said 'from \$2,699 +GST'	Yes (no price)
Confetti Design	Melbourne	Shopify	Not published	—	Yes (no price)

B. Monthly SEO plans

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
SEO First Page	Melbourne	Pkg 1 / 2 / 3	\$250 / \$490–\$790 / \$1,950 (GST ?)	GBP and on-site / 4–7 keywords / 10+ keywords	Yes
Social Space	AU	Essentials / Accelerate / Premium	\$249 / \$449 / \$749 inc GST	Bundled with a managed website	Yes

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
Low Cost SEO Plans	Sydney	Starter / Ultimate / Ult+	\$695 / \$1,970 / \$2,540 +GST	8 / 15+ / 22+ keywords	Yes
Sejuce Digital	AU	Standard / Momentum / Me	\$880 / \$1,700 / \$2,600 inc GST	No lock-in; 5–10 keywords, 4–8 blogs	Yes
BeKonstructive	Brisbane	Local / Starter / Growth / Accel	\$850 / \$1,400 / \$2,800 / \$4,200+ ex GST	— / 10 / 16 / 30+ hrs	Yes
EG Solutions	Sydney	Ongoing SEO	from \$990 (GST ?)	No lock-in	Yes
Web Apex	AU	Std / Pro / Adv / eCom	\$1,250 / \$1,750 / \$2,500 / \$3,500 ex GST	—	Yes
Digital Next	AU	Planet / Star / Galaxy	\$1,450 / \$1,850 / \$2,250 ex GST	5 / 8 / 12 hrs; month-to-month	Yes
Australian Web Experts	Melbourne	Local / Metro	\$1,490 / \$2,490 +GST	10 keywords with GBP, 1 article / 30+ keywords, 2 articles	Yes
Spicy Web	Melbourne	Bronze to Gold	\$2,200 / \$4,400 / \$6,600 +GST	Technical, on-page, off-page, links	Yes
SOUP Agency	Syd / Mel / Bris	Small / Med / Enterprise	\$2,500 / \$4,000 / \$6,000+ ex GST	Initial commitment required	Yes
Firewire Digital	AU	Campaigns	from \$2,500 ex GST	Custom after audit	Yes
Websites That Sell	AU	Local / Major city	from \$595 +GST; \$3,000–\$10,000+	The page contradicts itself on the minimum	Yes
SEO Melbourne	Melbourne	Foundations to Authority	\$1,000–\$2,500 / \$2,500–\$5,000 / \$5,000+	Ranges only; custom quotes	Yes
Melbourne SEO Consultant	Melbourne	Retainer	'Typically \$750–\$2,000'	No contract	Yes

C. Hosting, care & maintenance (monthly)

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
VisualWeb	Melbourne	WP Maintenance x4	\$32.95 / \$49.95 / \$69.95 / \$149.95 +GST	Updates, monitoring, backups	Yes
VisualWeb	Melbourne	Managed hosting x3	\$59 / \$107.50 / \$178.20 +GST	Hourly backups; 0 / 30 / 60 min of changes	Yes
Kitsune Creative	Melbourne	Care / Hosting + Care	\$62 / \$72 / \$74 +GST (billed yearly)	Updates, backups, security	Yes
Website4U	Melbourne	Starter / Plus / Pro	\$79 / \$149 / \$229 ex GST	30 / 60 / 120 min of edits; \$100/hr extra	Yes
GoldenWeb	Melbourne	Essential / Pro / VIP	\$129 / \$229 / \$349 +GST	1 / 2 / 4 hrs of updates	Yes
Fox & Lee	Melbourne	Essentials / Pro / Expert	\$139 / \$259 / \$549 inc GST	Benchmarks: brochure \$100–\$300	Yes
Dizian Digital	Melbourne	Care	from \$299 ex GST	Billing period unclear	Yes
Web Champion	Melbourne	Growth / Partner / CTO	\$2,400 / \$4,800 / \$9,600+ (GST ?)	Dev retainers: 20–80 hrs	Yes
EG Solutions	Sydney	Managed hosting	from \$30/mo +GST	After year 1	Yes
Dynamic Websites	Melbourne	Hosting + domain	\$260/yr inc GST	—	Yes
Foxie Web Design	Central Coast	Hosting	from \$160/yr	—	Yes
VentralIP	AU	WordPress hosting	'from \$11/mo'	Snippet only	Failed

D. Managed IT per user (for context)

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
Melbit	Melbourne	Essentials / Business	from \$79 / \$120–\$180 per user ex GST	1–5 / 5–200 staff	Yes
All IT Services	Sydney	Essentials / Core / Premium	\$60 (+\$210/hr) / \$124 / \$199 per user ex GST	Min users: none / 10 / 25	Yes
Milnsbridge	Sydney	Core / Growth / Enhanced	\$109 / \$119 / \$169 per seat ex GST	12-month term; \$125 onboarding	Yes

Provider	City	Package	Price (AUD)	Inclusions / notes	Verified
Espire IT	Melbourne	Support plans	'from \$35/user ex GST'	Snippet only	Failed
Intellect IT	Melbourne	—	Not published	Cites a market range of \$120–\$280 per user	Yes

Pricing guides & industry benchmarks

Guide	Stated ranges	URL
StudioHawk (Dec 2025)	SEO: entry \$500–\$1,000/mo; growth \$1,500–\$3,000; authority \$5,000+; \$150–\$300/hr; audits \$2k–\$5k	studiohawk.com.au/blog/seo-pricing/
Firewire (Jun 2026)	SEO typically \$1,500–\$5,000+/mo ex GST; packages cluster \$500–\$1,500; freelancers \$150–\$250/hr	firewiredigital.com.au/learn/seo/seo-cost-australia/
ThisJay (Apr 2026)	Local SEO: freelancers \$500–\$2,000/mo; small agencies \$1,500–\$3,500; large \$3,000–\$8,000+; one-off \$800–\$2,500	thisjay.com/blog/how-much-does-local-seo-cost-australia/
Spacewolf	Small-business SEO \$800–\$3,500/mo	spacewolf.au/blog/seo-packages-for-small-business
i4s (Mar 2026)	Small business SEO \$800–\$2,000/mo; mid-size \$2,000–\$5,000	i4s.au/seo-package-prices-australia/
Websites That Sell	Client averages: Melbourne \$4,062/mo, Sydney \$3,710, Brisbane \$4,699, Adelaide \$2,420 +GST	websitesatsell.com.au/seo/seo-costs/
Web Apex calculator	WordPress from \$6,500; e-com from \$12,500; Shopify \$10k–\$20k+; custom from \$9,500 ex GST	webapex.com.au/website-design-cost-calculator
Chillybin (Brisbane 2026)	Templated WP \$2,500–\$5,500; custom \$8k–\$20k+; hosting \$20–\$80/mo; maintenance \$150–\$500/mo	chillybin.co/website-cost-brisbane/
Dizian (Aug 2026)	Melbourne custom small-business sites \$3,000–\$7,000; \$150–\$300/hr	dizian.com.au/articles/web-design-cost-melbourne
Fox & Lee (Sep 2026)	WP care: brochure \$100–\$300/mo; lead-gen \$300–\$900; WooCommerce \$700–\$2,000+	foxandlee.com.au/wordpress-care-plan-maintenance-benchmarks-2026/

All websites checked

Fetches successfully (47 URLs)

- visualweb.com.au/pricing/
- melbits.com.au/services/pricing
- dynamicwebsites.com.au/web-design-packages/
- brucelangdon.com.au/small-business-website-package/
- socialspace.com.au/building-websites/web-design-pricing
- socialspace.com.au/local-seo
- christom.com.au/services/affordable-website-design/
- webapex.com.au/website-design-cost-calculator
- webapex.com.au/seo-cost-calculator
- spacewolf.au/blog/seo-packages-for-small-business
- studiohawk.com.au/blog/seo-pricing/
- thisjay.com/blog/how-much-does-local-seo-cost-australia/
- spicyweb.com.au/services/search-engine-optimisation/seo-packages
- bekonstruktivemarketing.com.au/seo-packages-pricing/
- sejucedigital.com.au/pricing/
- soupagency.com.au/seo/seo-packages/
- lowcostseoplans.com/seo-packages/
- egsolutions.com.au/affordable-web-design-sydney/
- codeandvisual.com.au/package/web-design/
- auswebdesign.com.au/website-pricing/
- webeasy.com.au/
- brandflow.au/prices
- website4u.com.au/website-care-melbourne/
- goldenweb.com.au/services/website-maintenance-plans/
- webchampion.com.au/care-plans/
- kitsunecreative.co/services/website-hosting-care-plans/

- confettidesign.com.au/shopify-website-packages/ (no prices)
- dizian.com.au/articles/web-design-cost-melbourne
- foxandlee.com.au/wordpress-care-plan-maintenance-benchmarks-2026/
- firewiredigital.com.au/learn/seo/seo-cost-australia/
- chillybin.co/website-cost-brisbane/
- swiftproductions.com.au/ecommerce/shopify-website-design (no prices)
- intellectit.com.au/managed-it-services-pricing-melbourne/
- allitservices.com.au/managed-it-support/pricing/
- milnsbridge.com.au/managed-it-services-pricing/
- seomelbourne.com/seo-pricing-melbourne/
- seofirstpage.com.au/local-seo-melbourne-services-prices-for-small-businesses/
- melbourneseoconsultant.com/seo-packages-melbourne/
- smallbusinesswebdesigns.net.au/pricing.html (partly readable)
- edgezonemedia.com/web-design-pricing
- foxiewebdesign.com/services/website-design-small-business-package/
- websiteshatsell.com.au/seo/seo-costs/
- i4s.au/seo-package-prices-australia/
- business.localsearch.com.au/websites
- digitalnext.com.au/seo-packages/
- australianwebexperts.com.au/seo-packages
- digitalon.com.au/small-business-website-packages

Failed to load (7 URLs)

- dygiphy.com.au/small-business-web-design/ (connection refused)
- pkseo.com.au/.../seo-packages-for-small-business/ (socket closed)
- wdsydney.com.au/pricing/ (domain not found)
- wpcreative.com.au/how-much-does-a-website-cost-in-australia/ (403)
- ventraip.com.au/blog/how-much-does-a-website-cost/ (connection refused)
- ventraip.com.au/web-hosting/wordpress-hosting/ (connection refused)
- espireit.com.au/support-plans.html (connection refused)

Method & caveats

Pages were fetched on 27 September 2026 with an automated tool that summarises page content. Prices can change without notice, and specials may expire. Sydney and Brisbane pages often don't say whether GST is included. The cheapest SEO plans are sometimes bundled with a website subscription, so they aren't directly comparable with SEO-only retainers. Recommended Scikit prices are our own judgement, not a market fact.